



IN BRIEF

VIKING EXPANSION

As Viking men explored and plundered foreign lands, women took charge at home. Raiders often brought female slaves back to lessen the load—or for their own pleasure.

700 CE

- **793** The English monastery of Lindisfarne is sacked in the earliest recorded Viking raid—an event defining the beginning of the Viking Age.

800 CE

- **820** The Oseberg burial takes place in Vestfold, Norway. A Viking queen is buried in a longship with a sacrificed female slave.
- **870** The Viking settlement of Iceland begins.
- **892** Viking chief Hastein invades England; he brings his wife and children with him.

900 CE

- **922** Arab merchant Ibn Fadlan witnesses the sacrifice of a slave girl at a Viking chief's funeral in Russia.
- **945–963** Olga (Helga) rules the Viking Rus kingdom of Kiev on behalf of her infant son.
- **965** Harald Bluetooth, king of Denmark, converts to Christianity—as do his people. Norway follows c. 995 and Sweden by c. 1100.

1000 CE

- **1000** Thjodhild, wife of Erik the Red, founds the first church in Greenland.
- **1010** Freydis, sister of Leif Eriksson, becomes joint leader of an expedition to Vinland.

1100 CE

- **1117** Icelandic Grágás law code commits Viking marriage laws to writing for the first time.

◀ **WOMEN ARE TAKEN CAPTIVE DURING A RAID BY THE VIKINGS IN 994 CE.**

